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PUBLICATIONS
(† denotes equal contribution)

25. K.-H. Wang, **R. Kumar**, P. Ma, J. Kim, B. Kim, C. V. Amanchukwu, "Fluoroalkyl-Functionalized Cyclic Ethers as Solvent for High-Voltage Batteries", *Chem. Commun.* (2026) (<https://doi.org/10.1039/D6CC01108J>) (Part of "2026 Pioneering Investigator Collection" Themed Collection) **Featured on the cover image**
24. J. Kim, K.-H. Wang, **R. Kumar**, P. Ma, C. V. Amanchukwu, "Generative Electrolyte Solvent and Formulation Discovery." *JACS Au* 6, 2288-2302 (2026). (Part of "Future Perspectives on Battery Chemistries" Special Issue)
23. **R. Kumar**[†], K.-H. Wang[†], C. V. Amanchukwu, "Using Electrolyte Solvent Embeddings to Guide Battery Electrolyte Discovery." *Mol. Syst. Des. Eng.* 11, 422-435 (2026) (<https://doi.org/10.1039/D5ME00188A>). (Part of "Festschrift in Honour of Juan de Pablo's 60th Birthday" Themed Collection) **Featured on the cover image**
22. P. Ma[†], **R. Kumar**[†], K.-H. Wang, C. V. Amanchukwu, "Active Learning Accelerates Electrolyte Solvent Screening for Anode-Free Lithium Metal Batteries." *Nat. Commun.* 16, 8396 (2025). (Part of "Initially Anode-less and Anode-free Batteries" Collection)
21. H. Fejzic, **R. Kumar**, R. J. Gomes, L. He, T. J. Houser, J. Kim, N. Molten, C. V. Amanchukwu. "Water Clustering Modulates Activity and Enables Hydrogenated Product Formation during Carbon Monoxide Electroreduction in Aprotic Media." *J. Am. Chem. Soc.* 147, 18445-18459 (2025).
20. **R. Kumar**, M. C. Vu, P. Ma, C. V. Amanchukwu. "Electrolytomics: A Unified Big Data Approach for Electrolyte Design and Discovery." *Chem. Mater.* 37, 2720-2734 (2025).
19. R. J. Gomes, **R. Kumar**, H. Fejzic, B. Sarkar, I. Roy, C. V. Amanchukwu. "Modulating Water Hydrogen Bonding within a Nonaqueous Environment Controls its Reactivity in Electrochemical Transformations" *Nat. Catal.* 7, 689-701 (2024).
18. E. S. Doyle, P. Mirmira, P. Ma, M. C. Vu, T. Hixson-Wells, **R. Kumar**, C. V. Amanchukwu. "Phase Morphology Dependence of Ionic Conductivity and Oxidative Stability in Fluorinated Ether Solid-State Electrolytes." *Chem. Mater.* 36, 5063-5076 (2024).
17. P. Ma, **R. Kumar**, M. C. Vu, K.-H. Wang, P. Mirmira, C. V. Amanchukwu. "Fluorination promotes lithium salt dissolution in borate esters for lithium metal batteries." *J. Mater. Chem. A* 12, 2479-2490 (2024).
16. P. V. Sarma[†], R. Nadarajan[†], **R. Kumar**, R. M. Patinharayil, N. Biju, S. Narayanan, G. Gao, C. S. Tiwary, M. Thalakulam, R. Kini, A. K. Singh, P. M. Ajayan, M. Shaajumon. "Growth of Highly Crystalline Ultrathin Two-Dimensional Selenene." *2D Mater.* 9, 045004 (2022).
15. R. Das, S. Sarkar, **R. Kumar**, S. D. Ramarao, A. Cherevotan, M. Jasil, C. P. Vinod, A. K. Singh, S. C. Peter. "Noble-Metal-Free Heterojunction Photocatalyst for Selective CO₂ Reduction to Methane upon Induced Strain Relaxation." *ACS Catal.* 12, 687-697 (2022).
14. L. Sharma[†], N. K. Katiyar[†], A. Parui[†], R. Das, **R. Kumar**, C. S. Tiwary, A. K. Singh, Aditi Halder, Krishanu Biswas. "Low-Cost High Entropy Alloy (HEA) for High-Efficiency Oxygen Evolution Reaction (OER)." *Nano Res.* 15, 4799-4806 (2022).
13. **R. Kumar**, and A. K. Singh. "Chemical Hardness-Driven Interpretable Machine Learning for Rapid Search of Photocatalysts." *NPJ Comput. Mater.* 7, 1-13 (2021).
12. S. Agarwal, **R. Kumar**, R. Arya, and A. K. Singh. "Rational Design of Single-Atom Catalysts for Enhanced Electrocatalytic Nitrogen Reduction Reaction." *J. Phys. Chem. C* 125, 12585-12593 (2021).
11. **R. Kumar**, and A. K. Singh. "Electronic Structure Based Intuitive Design Principle of Single-Atom Catalysts for Efficient Electrolytic Nitrogen Reduction." *ChemCatChem* 12, 5456-5464 (2020).
10. R. Nandan, R. Hemam, **R. Kumar**, A. K. Singh, C. Srivastava, and K. K. Nanda. "Inner Sphere Electron Transfer Promotion on Homogeneously Dispersed Fe-N_X Centres for Energy Efficient Oxygen Reduction Reaction." *ACS Appl. Mater. Interfaces* 12, 36026-36039 (2020).
9. P. Sarma, T. V. Vineesh, **R. Kumar**, V. Sreepal, A. K. Singh, and M. Shaajumon. "Nanostructured Tungsten Oxsulfide as an Efficient Electrocatalyst for Hydrogen Evolution Reaction." *ACS Catal.* 10, 6753-6762 (2020).
8. K. Urs[†], N. K. Katiyar[†], **R. Kumar**, K. Bishwas, A. K. Singh, C. S. Tiwary, and V. B. Kamble. "Multi-component (Ag-Au-Cu-Pd-Pt) Alloy Nanoparticles Decorated p-type 2D-Molybdenum Disulphide (MoS₂) for Enhanced Hydrogen Sensing" *Nanoscale* 12, 11830-11841 (2020).

7. N. K. Katiyar[†], S. Nellaiappan[†], **R. Kumar**[†], K. D. Malviya, K. G. Pradeep, A. K. Singh, S. Sharma, C. S. Tiwary, and K. Bishwas. "Formic Acid and Methanol Electro-oxidation and Counter Hydrogen Production Using Nano High Entropy Catalyst." *Mater. Today Ener.* 16, 100393 (2020).
 6. S. Nellaiappan[†], N. K. Katiyar[†], **R. Kumar**[†], A. Parui, K. D. Malviya, K. G. Pradeep, A. K. Singh, S. Sharma, C. S. Tiwary, and K. Bishwas. "High-Entropy Alloys as Catalysts for the CO₂ and CO Reduction Reactions: Experimental Realization." *ACS Catal.* 10, 3658–3663 (2020).
 5. S. Nellaiappan, **R. Kumar**, S. C., S. Irusta, J. A. Hachtel, J. C. Idrobo, A. K. Singh, C. S. Tiwary, and S. Sharma. "Electroreduction of Carbon Dioxide into Selective Hydrocarbon at Low Overpotential using Isomorphic Atomic Substitution in Copper Oxide." *ACS Sustainable Chem. Eng* 8, 179–189 (2020).
 4. R. K. Barik, **R. Kumar**, and A. K. Singh. "Topological Phases in Hydrogenated Group 13 Monolayers." *J. Phys. Chem. C* 123, 25985–25990 (2019).
 3. **R. Kumar**, D. Das, E. Munoz, and A. K. Singh. "Critical Sublattice Symmetry Breaking: A Universal Criterion for Dirac Cone Splitting." *J. Phys. Chem. C* 123, 23082–23088 (2019).
 2. A. P. Balan[†], S. Radhakrishnan[†], **R. Kumar**, R. Neupane, S. K. Sinha, L. Deng, C. A. de los Reyes, A. Apte, B. M. Rao, M. Paulose, R. Vajtai, C. W. Chu, G. Costin, A. A. Martí, O. K. Varghese, A. K. Singh, C. S. Tiwary, M. R. Anantharaman, and P. M. Ajayan, "A Non-van der Waals Two-Dimensional Material from Natural Titanium Mineral Ore Ilmenite." *Chem. Mater.* 30, 5923–5931 (2018).
 1. **R. Kumar**, D. Das, and A. K. Singh, "C₂N/WS₂ Van der Waals Type-II Heterostructure as a Promising Water Splitting Photocatalyst." *J. Catal.* 359, 143–150 (2018).
- REVIEW ARTICLES /PERSPECTIVE
2. H. Xin, J. Kitchin, N. Lopez, ..., **R. Kumar**, ..., Z. Zhang, "Transparent reporting for agentic catalysis enabled by artificial intelligence: Community guidelines and a publication checklist." *Chem Catal.* 6, 101755 (2026)
 1. **R. Kumar**, C. V. Amanchukwu, "AI-accelerated realization of next-generation batteries: *status quo* and outlook." *Curr. Opin. Chem. Eng.* 52, 101252 (2026) (<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.coche.2026.101252>). (Part of "Artificial Intelligence and Chemical Engineering" Special Issue).
- CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS
1. S. A. Eshiemogie, **R. Kumar**, C. V. Amanchukwu, "Data Preprocessing and Machine Learning Modelling for Battery Electrolyte Discovery." *2024 Int. Conf. Sci., Eng. Bus. Driv. Sustain. Dev. Goals (SEB4SDG)* (2024) (<https://doi.org/10.1109/seb4sdg60871.2024.10630085>).
- PREPRINTS
2. A. Roy, K. Shen, ..., **R. Kumar**, ..., I. Foster, B. Blaiszik, "From Knowledge to Action: Outcomes of the 2025 Large Language Model (LLM) Hackathon for Applications in Materials Science and Chemistry." *arXiv* (2026) (<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2605.03205>).
 1. M. Dey, **R. Kumar**, A. K. Singh, "Synergistic Interplay between Surface Polarons and Adsorbates for Photocatalytic Nitrogen Reduction on TiO₂(110)." *arXiv* (2026) (<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2604.09291>).
- AWARDS AND HONORS
11. Selected as Distinguished Staff Fellow at Oak Ridge National Laboratory (ORNL) (withdrawn to begin faculty appointment at TCG CREST) February 2026
 10. Selected as 2026 Research Corporation for Science Advancement (RCSA) Fellow (withdrawn to begin faculty appointment at TCG CREST) February 2026
 9. Named 2025 Rising Stars in Soft and Biological Matter, co-sponsored by University of Chicago & University of California San Diego December 2025
 8. Selected for the Future Faculty Mentoring Program by American Institute of Chemical Engineering (AIChE) October 2025
 7. CAS Future Leader Top 100 Award by American Chemical Society (ACS) March 2025
 6. Eric & Wendy Schmidt AI in Science Postdoctoral Fellow (Salary: \$80,000) January 2023 – January 2026
 5. Selected for Oxford Research Software Engineering (OxRSE) Workshop at University of Oxford, UK (travel grant; ~\$3000) June 2024 & September 2025

	4. All India Rank 38 in IIT-Joint Admission test for Master's (IIT-JAM) Examination (Scholarship: ₹16,000 per month during Master's at Indian Institute of Science)	February 2015
	3. IASc-INSa-NASI Summer Research Fellowship (organized by all three national academies of India) (Stipend: ₹8,000 per month)	May 2014 – July 2014
	2. Central Sector Scheme of Scholarship for College and University Students (Scholarship: ₹10,000 per annum)	2012 – 2015
	1. All-India Rank 54 in 2 nd Nationwide Interactive Math Olympiad	November 2007
ORAL PRESENTATIONS	13. "Accelerating next generation battery materials discovery using active learning." <i>2025 Rising Stars in Soft and Biological Matter</i> , (Virtual; Invited by Prof. Shrayesh Patel)	December 2025
	12. "Accelerating liquid electrolyte discovery for next-generation batteries using data-driven techniques." <i>ZERO Institute Seminar</i> , University of Oxford, OX, UK (Invited by Prof. David Howey)	September 2025
	11. "Accelerating electrolyte discovery for next-generation batteries." <i>Prof. Venkatasubramanian Viswanathan's Lab Group Meeting</i> , University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI (Invited by Prof. Venkatasubramanian Viswanathan)	August 2025
	10. "Accelerating electrolyte discovery for batteries." <i>2025 MRS Spring Meeting and Exhibit</i> , Seattle, WA	April 2025
	9. "Powering Next-Generation Batteries through Data Science in Synergy with Simulations and Experiments." <i>Faculty Candidates in CoMSEF, 2024 AIChE Annual Meeting</i> , San Diego, CA	October 2024
	8. "Data-Driven Accelerated Discovery of Novel Battery Materials." <i>Frontiers of Machine Learning on Materials Discovery Symposium, MS&T24 Technical Meeting and Exhibition</i> , Pittsburgh, PA (Invited by Dr. Rinkle Juneja)	October 2024
	7. "Accelerating realization of next-generation batteries through data-driven techniques." <i>Chemistry Colloquium</i> , Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, IL (Invited by Prof. Yuanbing Mao)	September 2024
	6. "Graph neural networks for electrolytes." <i>2024 University of Chicago Schmidt AI in Science Postdoctoral Fellows Retreat</i> , North Utica, IL	September 2024
	5. "AI-driven discovery of efficient materials for next-generation batteries." <i>Computational Materials Science and Engineering Gordon Research Seminar (GRS)</i> , Sunday River, ME (Invited by Prof. Aditya Nandy)	July 2024
	4. "Realizing next-generation batteries through AI and automation." <i>2024 AI+Science Schmidt Fellow Speaker Series</i> , University of Chicago, IL (Invited by Prof. Madeleine Torcasso)	April 2024
	3. "A Big Data Approach to Rational Design and Discovery of Electrolytes." <i>243rd ECS Meeting</i> , Boston, MA	May 2023
	2. "Chemical Hardness-Driven Interpretable Machine Learning for Rapid Search of Photocatalysts." <i>2021 MRS Fall Meeting and Exhibit</i> (Virtual)	December 2021
	1. "Electronic Structure Based Intuitive Design Principle of Single-Atom Catalysts for Efficient Electrolytic Nitrogen Reduction." <i>2021 MRS Spring Meeting and Exhibit</i> (Virtual)	April 2021

POSTER PRESENTATIONS (Selected)	5. "AI-driven realization of next-generation batteries." <i>AI+Science Summer School 2025</i> , Paris, France	July 2025
	4. "In Silico Materials Design and Discovery for Electrocatalysis and Energy Storage." Early career poster at <i>AI for Multidisciplinary Exploration and Discovery (AIMED) Workshop on Heterogeneous Catalysis</i> , Big Ten Conference Center, Rosemont, IL (Invited by Prof. Hongliang Xin)	October 2024
	3. "Achieving Sustainability through In Silico Materials Design and Discovery." <i>Computational Materials Science and Engineering Gordon Research Conference (GRC)</i> , Sunday River, ME	July 2024
	2. "How can AI Power Next-Generation Batteries?" <i>AI in Science Postdoctoral Fellowship 2023 Inaugural Convening</i> , University of Toronto, Canada	August 2023
	1. "Artificial Intelligence Powering Next-Generation Batteries." <i>University of Chicago and Caltech Conference on AI+Science</i> , University of Chicago, IL	March 2023
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	University of Chicago	
	2. Guest lecturer, <i>Thermodynamics of phase equilibria</i>	October 2025
	1. Guest lecturer, <i>Energy conversion and storage devices</i> (Additionally served as a panel judge for student final presentations, providing critical feedback and assessments)	March 2024 & February 2026
	Indian Institute of Science	
	2. Teaching assistant, <i>Computational modeling of materials</i> (Developed and taught new hands-on course content, including tutorials tailored to enhance practical learning, held weekly discussions, and graded exams)	January – May 2020
MENTORING EXPERIENCE	1. Teaching assistant, <i>Quantum chemistry and group theory</i> (Taught lectures, graded exams, and conducted exam performance review sessions)	August – December 2019
	TCG CREST	
	<i>Summer Intern:</i> 1. Sourabh Subhashish Panda (Physics)	May 2026 – July 2026
	<i>Postdoc:</i> 1. Samanvitha K. V. Shankar (Chemistry)	June 2026 – Present
	University of Chicago	
	<i>Undergraduates:</i> 1. Arnav Brahmasandra (Computer Science)	January 2023 – March 2024
	2. Zoe Umlauf (Computer Science)	January 2025 – June 2025
	3. Leyou Gessesew (Data Science; Wellesley College; <i>AI+Science Research Experience for Undergraduates (REU) Summer Lab Program</i>)	June – August 2025
	<i>Master's:</i> 4. Tarun Arora (Computer Science)	June 2023 – March 2024
	5. Jaemin Kim (Chemistry): Co-authored three publications	May 2023 – September 2025
	<i>Ph.D.:</i> 6. Emily Doyle: Co-authored one publication	May 2023 – February 2026
	7. Stanley Eshiemogie: Co-authored manuscript under preparation	Dec 2025 – February 2026
	RENEU program hosted by University of Chicago (remote)	
	<i>Undergraduate:</i> 1. Stanley Eshiemogie (University of Benin, Nigeria): Mentored a 10-week project on developing ML models for electrolytes, resulting in a co-authored article in a conference proceedings (current position: Ph.D. student at UChicago)	June 2023 – August 2023
	Indian Institute of Science	
	<i>Undergraduate:</i> 1. Rakesh Arya (Chemistry major): Co-authored one publication and mentoring contributed to an undergraduate thesis	January 2018 – January 2019
	<i>Master's:</i> 2. Arko Parui: Co-authored 2 publications and mentoring contributed to a master's thesis	August 2018 – July 2019
	3. Pooja Gakhad: Mentoring contributed to a master's thesis	December 2020 – July 2021

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT	2025 Oxford Research Software Engineering Workshop <i>Location:</i> Doctoral Training Centre, University of Oxford, UK <i>Description:</i> Led a team of 7 members to develop a graphical interface curAITor-agent for autonomous scientific data extraction using LLMs and AI agents (open-sourced at https://github.com/ritesh001/curaitor-agent) <i>Travel fund:</i> Schmidt Sciences, New York, NY	September 2025
	2025 LLM Hackathon for Applications in Materials Science & Chemistry <i>Location:</i> Virtual <i>Description:</i> Co-developed a tool AtomBridge for scientific automated conversion of STEM images to crystal structures using LLMs and computer vision (open-sourced at https://github.com/dpalmer-anl/AtomBridge) <i>Award:</i> 2025 Visionary Award	September 2025
	2024 Oxford Research Software Engineering Workshop <i>Location:</i> Doctoral Training Centre, University of Oxford, UK <i>Description:</i> Co-developed a graphical interface curAITor for scientific data extraction using LLMs (open-sourced at https://github.com/mm500/curaitor) <i>Travel fund:</i> Schmidt Sciences, New York, NY	June 2024
	Academic Job Market Summer Camp <i>Location:</i> University of Chicago, IL <i>Description:</i> Workshop on writing effective application materials for faculty jobs	July 2023
PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS	American Institute of Chemical Engineers (AIChE)	2025 – 2026
	American Institute of Chemical Engineers (AIChE)	2024 – 2025
	The Electrochemical Society (ECS)	2023 – 2024
	Materials Research Society (MRS)	2020 – 2022
COMPUTING ALLOCATIONS	National Science Foundation (NSF) ACCESS <i>Role:</i> PI <i>Award (system & CPU/GPU hours & estimated value):</i> 2. Discovery allocation (Purdue Anvil AI & GPU: 1000 & \$234.51)	October 2025
	1. Discovery allocation (Purdue Anvil & CPU: 625,000 & \$2,600.00)	October 2024
	Research Computing Center, University of Chicago <i>Role:</i> PI <i>Award (system & CPU hours):</i> 3. Research allocation (Midway & 100,000)	October 2025
	2. Research allocation (Midway & 100,000)	October 2024
	1. Startup allocation (Midway & 10,000)	August 2024
SERVICE & OUTREACH	16. Reviewer, <i>Nature Communications</i> (2), <i>ACS Applied Energy Materials</i> (1), <i>Digital Discovery</i> (6), <i>Journal of Open Source Software</i> (2), <i>Catalysts</i> (1), <i>Chemistry – A European Journal</i> (1), <i>Materials Genome Engineering</i> (1)	November 2024 – June 2026
	17. Contributed to blog post “Unlocking the Potential of Lithium Batteries with New Electrolyte Solutions”, <i>Chemistry World</i> (published by RSC) (https://www.chemistryworld.com/news/machine-learning-cuts-complexity-of-computational-calculations-in-catalysis/4023047.article)	March 2026
	15. Organizer, <i>2024-25 AI+Science Schmidt Fellows Speaker Series</i> , University of Chicago, IL (Revised second edition of the seminar series based on feedback and invited Prof. Aaron Dinner from University of Chicago Chemistry, Prof. Claire Donnat from University of Chicago Statistics, and Prof. Chibueze Amanchukwu)	October 2024 – May 2025
	14. Session chair, <i>Frontiers of Machine Learning on Materials Discovery Symposium, MS&T24 Technical Meeting and Exhibitio</i> , Pittsburgh, PA (Invited by Dr. Rinkle Juneja)	October 2024

13. Discussion leader, *Computational Materials Science and Engineering Gordon Research Seminar*, Sunday River, ME (**Invited by Prof. Aditya Nandy**) July 2024
12. Session chair and organizer, *2024 AI+Science Summer School*, University of Chicago, IL (Co-developed program for an multidisciplinary summer school for undergraduate and graduate students and postdocs, reviewed their applications, and invited Prof. Pedram Hassanzadeh from University of Chicago Geophysics, Dr. Zachary Ulissi from Meta FAIR, Dr. Muratahan Aykol from Google DeepMind) July 2024
11. Reviewer, *US DOE Office of Science Graduate Student Research (SCGSR) program's 2024 Solicitation 1* (reviewed 3 Ph.D. student proposals) June 2024
10. Organizer, *2024 AI+Science Hackathon*, University of Chicago, IL (Co-created hackathon, fostering a collaborative problem-solving in scientific AI) May 2024
9. Resource person, "Introduction to use of AI in teaching and learning." *Workshop on AI for teaching & learning*, Sri Venkateswara College, India (Presented 3 hours-long tutorial for workshop attended by >80 faculties) (Virtual, **Invited by Prof. Sharda Pasricha**) May 2024
8. Technical blogger, "Unlocking the Potential of Lithium Batteries with New Electrolyte Solutions", Data Science Institute Insights, University of Chicago, IL (<https://datascience.uchicago.edu/insights/unlocking-the-potential-of-lithium-batteries-with-new-electrolyte-solutions/>) February 2024
7. Moderator and organizer, *2023-24 AI+Science Schmidt Fellows Speaker Series*, University of Chicago, IL (Co-developed and moderated a seminar series, enhancing academic dialogue and networking among scholars and invited Dr. Logan Ward from Argonne National Laboratory) October 2023 – May 2024
6. Discussion leader, *Postdoc Program Leaders Community Forum*, organized by National Postdoctoral Association (NPA) (Virtual, **Invited by Thomas P. Kimbis**) August 2023
5. Moderator, *2023 AI+Science Summer School*, University of Chicago, IL July 2023
4. Judge, *Students Slam Contest at 243rd ECS Meeting*, Boston, MA (**Invited by Prof. Lin Ma and Prof. Betar Gallant**) May 2023
3. Demonstration volunteer, Battery fabrication demonstration at *Science Works*, Museum of Science and Industry, Chicago, IL October 2022
2. Incharge, High-performance computing facilities (hardware & software) at Materials Research Centre, Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore August 2018 – July 2020
1. Demonstration volunteer, *2018 IISc Open day*, Institute of Science, Bangalore March 2018